donated 100,000 rupees from his own pocket to 'help them in their work.' Notably, he also lauded the group's efforts to liberate Kashmir.[75]

JuD got more than pocket money, however, as the government channeled funds to it for reconstruction in Pakistan-administered Kashmir.[76] This enabled the group to expand its footprint there and to operate a number of relief camps, some of which doubled as recruiting grounds.[77] Lashkar also received huge charitable donations, much of which mysteriously disappeared. According to the US Department of Treasury, JuD used its relief wing Idara Khidmat-e-Khalq as well as its network of offices, madaris, mosques and other fundraising mechanisms to exploit the earthquake in order to raise money to support its militant activities.[78] Six months after the earthquake the US designated JuD and Idara Khidmat-e-Khalq as terrorist organizations. It stated that to evade sanctions Lashkar-e-Taiba had renamed itself Jamaat-ul-Dawa, which had established Idara Khidmat-e-Khalq as a 'public welfare organization that it utilizes to collect funds and undertake other activities.'[79] JuD responded by posting on its website a letter to then US Treasury Secretary Henry Paulson refuting claims it had used earthquake donations to support terrorist operations.[80] The group need not have worried too much. Unlike in 2002 when Islamabad followed Washington's ban of Lashkar, this time none was forthcoming. Some analysts believed Musharraf sent a dangerous message by refusing to follow Washington's lead, and ascribed his reluctance to do so to the extensive aid work JuD undertook following the earthquake.[81] In reality, the group was already heavily insinuated into Pakistani society and the earthquake provided the Musharraf regime with an opportunity to identify its relief work as a reason not to ban it. Certainly, JuD's utility and reputation as a service provider contributed to the state's unwillingness to act against it, but this was also a function of Lashkar's efficacy as a proxy against India.

Fighting the 'Good Fight'

The Musharraf regime had clamped down on cross-LoC infiltrations after the December 2001 attack on India's Parliament, but by early spring it had once again begun encouraging militant activity in Indian-administered Kashmir. A second pause followed after Lashkar militants executed the